

This is the most accurate way to prepare ...b7-b5.

14 Be3

White could also contemplate 14 a4 to stop ...b7-b5 but after 14...c4!
15 Be3 Nc5 16 Bxc5 (otherwise the knight infiltrates on d3)
16...Qxc5+ 17 Kh1 Nd7! the black pieces co-ordinate well.

14...b5 15 a3 Nb6! 16 e5

16 Bf2 is an important alternative. White more or less abandoned this move after the game Kozul-Nunn, Wijk aan Zee 1991. Play continued 16...Nc4 17 Qc2 Nd7 18 Be2 Rab8 19 a4 b4 20 Bxc4? bxc3 21 b3 a6! (this keeps the bishop out of b5) 22 Rec1 Nb6 23 Bf1 c4! 24 Bxc4 Nxc4 25 bxc4 Rb2 with a winning position for Black. Vaisser, however, has tried to rehabilitate this line for White. Instead of 20 Bxc4 he gives 20 Nb5! Nxb2 21 Nxd6 b3 22 Qb1 Nxa4 23 Ra3! as unclear. To be honest, nobody really knows what's going on in this position.

16...Nc4! 17 exf6 Nxe3 18 Rxe3 Rxe3 19 fxg7 Rae8 (Diagram 4)

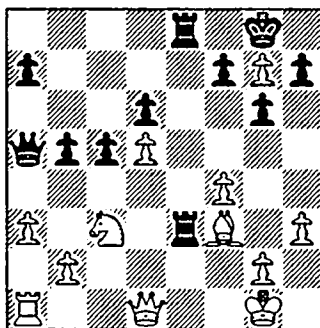


Diagram 4

Black has more than enough play

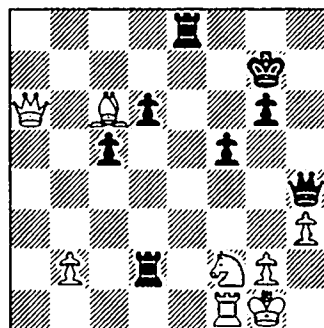


Diagram 5

White forces Black to find the win

This is the position Black had in mind when he embarked on the complications with 15...Nb6. White has a slight material advantage but this is compensated for by the fact that the black rooks are extremely active and the mobility of the white bishop is restricted by the pawn on d5. The pawn on g7 is of course doomed.

20 f5 b4 21 axb4 Qxb4 22 Qd2 Qb4! 23 fxg6 hxg6 24 Rf1 a6! 25 Nd1

Amazingly enough, this is the first new move of the game. Previously 25 Qf2 Qd4 26 Kh1 R3e5! had been played. White can probably hold the ending but it is more pleasant for Black.

25...R3e5 26 Nf2 f5 27 Bd1?! Kxg7 28 Qa5?! Rxd5 29 Bf3 Rd4 30 Qxa6 Rd2! 31 Bc6?? (Diagram 5)

White totally lost the plot over the last few moves and he caps it off with an outright blunder. 31 Qa3! still offered hope.

31...Re1!

Now 32 Rxe1 Qxf2+ 33 Kh2 Qxe1 just loses a piece. Black is threatening 32...Qxf2+ anyway and the only way to stave off immediate defeat is by 32 Nh1. After the game my opponent said that he would rather resign than play such a sick move.

32 Qb7+ Kh6 33 Ng4+ fxg4 34 Qf7 Rxf1+ 35 Qxf1 Kg7! White resigns

Game 48

□ Vaisser ■ Bauer

French Cup 1992

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 f4 0-0 6 Nf3 c5 7 d5 e6 8 Be2 exd5 9 cxd5 Re8 10 e5

This leads to enormous complications. White can also defend his e-pawn:

1) Not with 10 Qc2? as there is the trick 10...Nxe4! 11 Nxe4 Bf5 12 Bd3 Bxe4 13 Bxe4 Qe7 14 Nd2 f5 when Black regains the piece and remains a pawn to the good.

2) 10 Nd2, however, is an important alternative. The current view is that Black obtains good play after 10...Na6 11 0-0 Rb8!.

10...dxe5 11 fxe5 Ng4 12 Bg5

12 0-0 Nxe5 leads to a similar sort of position. The passed d-pawn is always going to provide White with some compensation for the pawn.

12...Qb6

After this move Black will at least get a pawn for his troubles. If he plays 12...f6 he will have no compensation for his suffering. A typical continuation is 13 exf6 Bxf6 14 Qd2 Bxg5 15 Qxg5 Qxg5 16 Nxg5 with an advantageous endgame for White.

13 0-0 Nxe5 14 Nxe5

14 d6 is also played quite often. Vaisser gives the following exciting variation as best play: 14...c4+! 15 Kh1 Qxb2! 16 Rc1 Nxf3 17 Bxf3 Bxc3 18 Rb1! Qxa2 19 Bd5 Bf5 20 Rxf5 gxf5 21 Bxf7+ Kxf7 22 Qh5+ Kf8 23 Bh6+ Bg7 24 Qxf5+ Kg8 25 Qd5+ Kh8 26 Bxg7+ Kxg7 27 Qg5+ with a draw by perpetual check.

14...Bxe5 15 Bc4 (Diagram 6)

White plans an attack against the f7-square.

15...Bf5!? 16 Nb5

White needs to play d6 even if it costs him dear.

16...a6! 17 d6!

White can't back out now. He is willing to sacrifice the kitchen sink to get at the black king.

17...axb5 18 Bxf7+! Kxf7 19 Rxf5+! gxf5 20 Qh5+ Kf8!

Vaisser relates how for many years this move was thought to lose be-